

Cover Letter

Yongjun Rong
Cherry Hill, NJ, USA, 08003
rongyj@hotmail.com
856-408-4027
LinkedIn | GitHub

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Hiring Manager
River
[Company Address]
Columbus, OH

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am thrilled to apply for the Staff Software Engineer position at River, where my passion for building scalable, reliable systems and my extensive experience across the web stack align seamlessly with your mission to create the world's most trusted Bitcoin-powered financial institution. With over 20 years of expertise in designing and delivering high-performance applications, I am eager to lead technical initiatives, mentor engineers, and contribute to River's innovative Elixir-based platform.

In my current role as Director of Cloud Architecture at Biophy, I architected a modular, scalable platform using Python, FastAPI, and AWS (S3, Lambda, Kubernetes), ensuring robust performance for an AI-powered RAG system. I led the design of event-driven microservices and implemented CI/CD pipelines with Jenkins, achieving high reliability and maintainability. At McKinsey & Company, I spearheaded genAI system development, presenting technical strategies to senior leadership and aligning solutions with business goals. While my primary experience is with Python, Java, and TypeScript, I am enthusiastic about transitioning to Elixir and Phoenix, leveraging my proven ability to master new languages and frameworks, as demonstrated by my rapid adoption of TypeScript at Yotascale.

My experience building production systems at scale equips me to tackle River's technical challenges. At Yotascale, I designed a cross-cloud cost analytics platform using Kubernetes and PostgreSQL, optimizing data models for performance and scalability. At Comcast, I developed secure, high-traffic APIs with robust testing practices, ensuring web security fundamentals like authentication and data integrity. My fintech experience at Barclays, where I architected distributed systems for financial data processing, aligns with River's focus on secure, reliable financial services. Additionally, my curiosity about Bitcoin and blockchain technologies, evidenced by personal projects exploring cryptocurrency APIs, fuels my excitement to contribute to River's vision.

As a technical leader, I have a proven track record of mentoring engineers and

fostering excellence. At Biophy, I guided teams on Clean Architecture and AWS best practices, while at Gigster, I led cross-functional teams to deliver scalable solutions in fast-paced environments. My ability to propose innovative solutions, eliminate technical roadblocks, and collaborate with product management ensures alignment with company objectives. I am inspired by River's commitment to delightful, user-centric products and am eager to bring my ownership mindset, high-quality coding standards, and mentorship skills to your team.

Thank you for considering my application. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute to River's mission and would welcome the chance to discuss how my expertise can drive your technical initiatives. Please feel free to contact me at 856-408-4027 or rongyj@hotmail.com to schedule a conversation.

Sincerely,
Yongjun Rong